

PAIGE TOWNSEND

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Human-Computer Interaction student with hands-on experience leading end-to-end user research involving interviews, usability testing, and synthesis to build accessible, user-centered product designs.

EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

Jun 2027

B.S. in Informatics — Human-Computer Interaction Specialization

Relevant Coursework: Data Management, Human-Computer Interaction, Data Visualization, Project Management, Application Design

SKILLS

Research Methods: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Survey Design, Concept Testing, Competitive Analysis, Persona Development

Design Tools: Figma, FigJam, Wireframing, High-Fidelity Prototyping

Technical: Python, Java, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, MySQL, Web APIs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

INsite Lab + TLC Lab

Aug 2025 – Present

UX Researcher and Designer, Interdisciplinary Research Fellow

Irvine, CA

- Lead user research with professors to identify accessibility needs, translating findings into Figma wireframes and mockups.
- Partner with a PhD student to translate ML-flagged deictic phrases into accessible visual feedback for lecture recordings.

UC Irvine Department of Informatics

Sep 2026 – Present

Course Reader, INF 121: Software Design: Applications

Irvine, CA

- Grade multi-week application design deliverables for 77 students, applying structured rubrics across homework, design studio projects, and exams
- Collaborate weekly with course TA and fellow readers to align grading rubrics and resolve scoring inconsistencies across design studio submissions
- Hold office hours to support students on application and interaction design concepts, including structured decision-making frameworks (e.g., GACIOD matrices) and interactive system requirements

UCI Division of Teaching Excellence and Innovation (DTEI)

Sep 2025 – Sept 2026

Digital Accessibility (Consultant → Supervisor → Project Manager)

Irvine, CA

- Led and mentor a team of 10+ consultants, setting the standard for **WCAG-aligned** remediation across **42 courses and 44 faculty members**.
- Coordinated **156 consultation sessions** supporting **133 faculty members**, scoping requests and prioritizing workload across the team.
- Supported faculty training on YuJa Panorama and accessibility workflows (assisting with Q&A and hands-on practice) to improve adoption of **inclusive teaching practices**.

CCC Security Center

Jul 2025 – Sep 2025

SOC Analyst Intern

Santa Clarita, CA

- Led a team in conceptualizing a Python script leveraging BitSight APIs to automate cybersecurity **threat detection**, applying open-source intelligence tools to **investigate incidents across 116 schools** state-wide.

PROJECTS

INsite Lab + TLC Lab; Clarity Coach – UX Designer

Aug 2025 - Present

- Design and prototype a dashboard that visualizes inaccessible language in recorded lecture videos.
- Conduct usability testing interviews with professors to validate accessibility and user flow.
- Iterate on dashboard information architecture based on usability findings, prioritizing clarity for non-technical faculty users.

FUSION ICS Project — Kain Na!

Nov 2025 – May 2026

- Partnered with a design team to build a cultural connection platform connecting Filipino Americans to their heritage through food.
- Led user interviews to uncover community needs, shaping a family-recipe-centered concept grounded in real user stories.
- Designed a recipe card pop-up component surfacing key context at a glance: creator, prep duration, and dish origin.
- Built an **ingredient substitution search feature**, prioritizing clarity and accessibility for novice cooks navigating unfamiliar ingredients.

LEADERSHIP

Hack at UCI: Intern → Organizer → Co-Director; VenusHacks: Co-President

Jul 2024 – Mar 2026

- Directed sponsor relations across two UCI hackathons (400+ and 200+ annual participants), raising \$49,000+ combined and managing 80+ sponsor relationships
- Led and mentored 8+ new organizers while co-directing a 40+ student team, standardizing sponsorship documentation and outreach pipelines used across both events
- Oversaw a combined \$10,000+ in event budget as Co-President of UCI's only women-centric hackathon